

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

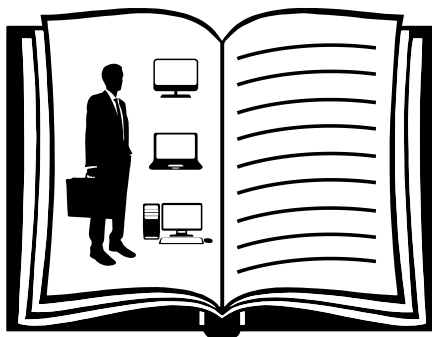
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Let's Start!

Programming Languages Hall of Fame



Learning Outcome:

Describe common activities at work to a visitor using short sentences in familiar spoken and written situations.

Give detailed and important information regarding to the history of language programming in different periods of time.

Ask your partner:

- How do you think computers were programmed before the creation of programming languages?
- Which programming languages do you know?
- Have you ever used a programming language? How was the experience?

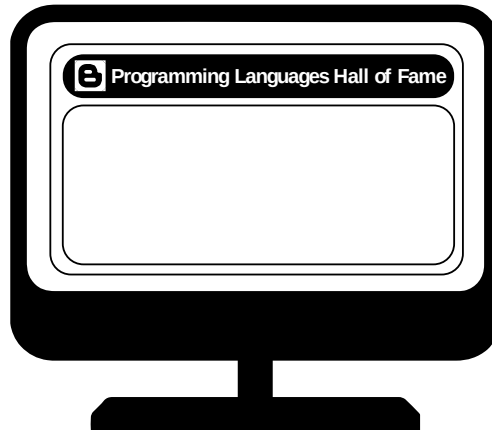
Can Do Statements:

- I can read and write about the role of some important people for software programming.
- I can write a short text to explain the importance of certain people in language programming.
- I can identify key features related to people and software programming by reading a text.



Let's Explore!

Here's a blog entry on some important people in the computer science world.



Instructions: Read the text below.

I'm going to talk about a presentation I attended in the Computer Science Fair. I was wandering around the school campus when I saw this poster saying "Programming Languages Hall of Fame", so I immediately wanted to see what it was about. As if they were rock stars, all the profiles of the people involved in the development of programming languages were exposed.

Here you'll find a glimpse of some of those important people in computer science but first, let's remark upon some basic concepts. Programming languages are used to communicate instructions to a machine; they also make algorithms visible. A long time ago, computers didn't need these languages, for decimal or binary forms were the paths for communicating orders.

The first profile that I read was from Charles Babbage (1791-1811), an English mathematician who created the concept of a computer that can be programmed. His invention is the benchmark of programming languages. When I was reading about him, I couldn't believe my eyes because I thought all the inventions related to computers were made in the 20th century.

German engineer Konrad Zuse (1910-1995) was another important figure, he invented the first programmable computer, the Z3. What I like about this machine is that it had two predecessors, which means that it didn't appear out of the blue. Talking about more recent contributions, in 1949 John Mauchly (1907-1980) developed the Short Code, which was the first higher-level language made for an electronic computer.

From Alan Cooper (1952), the creator of Visual Basic, to Guido van Rossum (1956), the inventor of Python, all these people have been essential for the development and evolution of programming languages. I'm writing this blog entry thanks to them since programming languages make every move in a computer possible. What do you think about this post? Leave your comments!



Let's Practice!

Did you know these celebrities?

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to complete each sentence.

- | | | | | | |
|----|--------------------------------------|----|--|----|---------------------------------------|
| 1. | <input type="text" value="reads"/> | 2. | <input type="text" value="invent"/> | 3. | <input type="text" value="watching"/> |
| | <input type="text" value="reading"/> | | <input type="text" value="inventing"/> | | <input type="text" value="watch"/> |
| | <input type="text" value="read"/> | | <input type="text" value="invented"/> | | <input type="text" value="watched"/> |

1. Yesterday at this time, I was _____ about Charles Babbage, his invention is the benchmark of language programming.
2. I _____ searching about Konrad Zuse, the engineer who invented the Z3, when my friend called me.
3. While we were _____ the Programming Languages Hall of Fame, a friend told me about John Mauchly, the engineer who developed the Short Code.



Let's Practice!

Let me tell you something about some great inventors.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. Cooper, / about / Basic. / Visual / my / assignment / I'm / creator / of / Alan / the / doing

2. Python. / inventor / the / Mr. / of / Guido / about / Rossum, / always / Adams / speaks / Van

3. about / I'm / Short / Mauchly, / Code. / the / John / inventor / of / the / Reading



Extension Activity

Let's meet some important people in software programming.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look for information about a computer scientist important in the software programming history.
- Take notes about the information you are reading.
- Write a report to show the computer scientist you have chosen.
- Mention the main contributions that this computer scientist has provided to the software programming world.
- Use past continuous, simple present tense and present continuous in your report.
- Show your report to your teacher.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

- I search information about a computer scientist important in the software programming history. ☐ ☐
- I say the main contributions that this computer scientist has provided to the software programming world. ☐ ☐
- I Use past continuous, simple present tense and present continuous in my sentences. ☐ ☐
- I write a report to show important people in the history of software programming. ☐ ☐



Target Words

- **wander** (verb): to walk with no specific plan in mind
e.g. I was wandering around the school campus when I saw this poster saying "Programming Languages Hall of Fame", so I immediately wanted to see what it was about.
- **remark upon** (verb): to comment on something
e.g. Let's remark upon some basic concepts.
- **Z3** (noun): electromechanical computer created by Konrad Zuse in 1941
e.g. Konrad Zuse (1910-1995) was another important figure, he invented the first programmable computer, the Z3.
- **benchmark** (noun): synonym for cornerstone or standard
e.g. His invention is the benchmark of programming languages.
- **glimpse** (noun): a quick look
e.g. Here, you'll find a glimpse of some of those important people in computer science
- **out of the blue** (expression): used to say that something appears out of nowhere
e.g. What I like about this machine is that it had two predecessors, which means that it didn't appear out of the blue.



Learning Points

Past Continuous in Affirmative

We use the **past continuous** tense to describe events that took place for a period of time in the past.

Past continuous helps to describe the setting or environment in a story: "*She knocked on the door and **the dog was barking.***"

This tense is also used to talk about an action interrupted by another action. Example:

"I was reading and my aunt asked me for help."

Use the past continuous to talk about simultaneous actions in the past. Example:

"I was watching TV while **she was preparing breakfast.**"

In order to make an affirmative sentence using the past continuous, follow this structure:

Subject + verb to be in past + verb ending in -ing + complement.

I **was reading** about the history of programming languages.

Remember the conjugation of **verb to be** in past:

Pronoun	Verb to be in past
I	was
You	were
He	was
She	was
It	was
We	were
They	were

Examples

- *I was wandering, when I saw this poster saying "Programming Languages Hall of Fame".*
- *When I was reading about him, I couldn't believe my eyes because I thought all the inventions related to computers were made in the 20th century.*
- *I'm writing this blog entry thanks to them since programming languages make every move in a computer possible.*





Learning Points

Simple Present Tense and Present Continuous Review

Simple present tense and present continuous tense are both used to talk about actions or events that take place in the present. However, there are some slight differences between them.

Pay attention to the following chart:

Tense	Main characteristics
Simple present	You can use this tense to talk about habits, routines or facts. Examples: <i>Code writers need to know how to use programming languages.</i> <i>What programming language do you like the most? I don't like Python, I prefer Pearl.</i>
Present continuous	It's mainly used for expressing actions that are happening at the moment. Example: What are you doing? I am waiting for the computer to download the file. These are other uses for present continuous: -To talk about temporary actions that take place only for a period of time Example: She is studying software engineering this semester. -To talk about current actions Example: The code writers are checking the scripts.

Examples

- *I'm writing this blog entry thanks to them since programming languages make every move in a computer possible.*
- *What do you think about this post? Leave your comments!*





Learning Points

Understanding What Coordination is

Have you ever had problems when writing a text because you don't know how to connect ideas? Well, there is a process in writing called coordination. Let's see how it can help you.

Let's consider the next two sentences:

1. *Programming languages are necessary for software development.*
2. *They translate instructions to a machine.*

How can we connect these two ideas? Let's see:

*Programming languages are necessary for software development, **for** they translate instructions to a machine.*

We use conjunctions, like **for** to join two complete sentences in order to make writing more fluent. In the chart below, you're going to find a group of coordinating conjunctions that can be very useful:

Conjunction	It's used to...	Example
for	Give a reason or explain a cause	<i>Understanding how programming languages work is difficult, for you need to know about syntax.</i>
and	Link two ideas	<i>Code writers need to know the programming language very well, and they should also be very attentive when writing the scripts.</i>
nor*	Point out something negative	<i>It's not easy to use Perl, nor is it to use Python.</i>
but	Express contrast	<i>People have seen zillions of computers, but most of them don't know how to program them.</i>
or	Give an alternative	<i>They choose a major in math, or they go for software engineering.</i>
yet	Express possibility or contrast	<i>Many people know how to use an app, yet they don't know the programming process behind it.</i>
so	Talk about a result	<i>Internet changes rapidly, so programming languages developers need to be aware of those changes.</i>





Learning Points

*When using **nor**, you need to make a grammatical inversion in the second sentence. In other words, it's mandatory to place the auxiliary verb before the noun, as if you were making a yes/no question.

Tip: It's a good idea to remember these conjunctions with the mnemonic "**FANBOYS**". This way, you'll hardly forget the words.

For connecting two sentences, you can also use **semicolons** and **conjunctive adverbs**. In the following chart, the process for linking sentences is explained:

Semicolons	Semicolons and conjunctive adverbs
Use semicolons when the two sentences are closely related. <u>Example:</u> <i>Programming languages keep evolving; they are created according to the needs spotted by the developer.</i>	Use a semicolon, a conjunctive adverb and a comma for connecting two complete sentences. <u>Example:</u> <i>Programming languages are difficult to learn; however, if you practice writing code, you'll get the hang of it.</i> Here's a list of some conjunctive adverbs you might find useful: -However -Moreover -Nevertheless -Therefore -Then

Examples

- *A long time ago, computers didn't need these languages, for decimal or binary forms were the paths for communicating orders.*
- *Programming languages are used to communicate instructions to a machine; they also make algorithms visible.*
- *Here, you'll find a glimpse of some of those important people in computer science, but first, let's remark upon some basic concepts.*

